# AKANCHA SHARMA

United Kingdom | akancha.jobmail@gmail.com | +44 74244 43929 | LinkedIn | Portfolio

## Summary

AI strategy professional who helps businesses decide where AI should cut manual effort and where people should stay in charge. I map workflows, score automation opportunities and design practical AI solutions using generative AI, forecasting models and governance frameworks. I keep my skills current through Microsoft Learn, completing new AI courses as the market adopts them.

## Experience

**Business Support & Events Officer** | *New Forest Business Partnership, Lymington* *Sep 2026 – Present*

- **AI Process Ownership:** Own the search for where AI can reduce manual effort across a not-for-profit serving 9,000 businesses, applying AI management frameworks to decide where automation earns its place.
- **Flagship Delivery:** Run the 21st Brilliance in Business Awards end to end (sponsors, nominations, finalists, ceremony) and lead planning for the New Forest Business Show from scratch, including stakeholder mapping, sponsor sourcing and budget.

**Business Development Intern** | *Eventage Trade Fair & Events Pvt. Ltd, Siliguri* *Dec 2024 – Jan 2025*

- **Outbound Sales & Delivery:** Made 150+ daily outbound calls to invite architects, designers and trade buyers to CONWOO 2025, then ran registration under peak footfall across three live event days.

## Education

**MSc Management and Artificial Intelligence** *University of Southampton 2025–2026*

- **Dissertation:** Design features of an AI-enabled platform to standardise tea tasting and grading in tea trading businesses.
- **Scholarships:** Dean's Scholarship and Excellence Scholarship, awarded on academic merit.
- **Roles:** Student Ambassador for the University (May 2026 – Present); elected Course Representative, mediating between the cohort and Business School faculty across three formal feedback meetings.

**BBA Global Business, *First Class*** *Inspiria Knowledge Campus 2022–2025*

- Won 5+ competitions including Case Quest Vol. 2 & 3 (Best Team and Most Innovative Solution); Academic Co-Chair, Global Business department.

## Projects

- **AI Strategy for Honasa Consumer (Mamaearth):** Evaluated AI in sentiment analysis, product prioritisation and personalisation for a D2C brand against Porter's Five Forces.
- **Daily T, AI-Powered Functional Tea Venture:** Designed a five-layer AI architecture and 18-month roadmap using Gaussian Process Regression, Prophet and Isolation Forest.
- **AKANCHA, AI Personal Shopping and Styling Platform:** Designed a recommendation and expert-styling platform sized across 60M+ potential users and benchmarked against Stitch Fix.
- **AI Ethics in Higher Education Assessment:** Proposed a hybrid governance model balancing human accountability with AI-enabled consistency monitoring.
- **Calvin Klein Digital Transformation:** Analysed AI-enabled recruitment, hybrid work and performance management for people-centred change at a global fashion company.
- **Detrash Digital Marketing Strategy:** Built an integrated content and influencer strategy for a UK sustainable watch brand using SOSTAC, STP and POEM.
- **Toffee Inc Supply Chain Optimisation:** Applied EOQ modelling and moving-average demand forecasting to cut carrying and manufacturing costs by 96%.
- **Labour Market Analytics for Business Graduates:** Found that 67% of graduate listings prioritise communication skills, with tool training the largest preparation gap.
- **Velocity Inc Workforce Engagement:** Diagnosed disengagement at a cloud and e-commerce firm and proposed fixes across motivation, leadership and inclusion.
- **boAt Brand and Marketing Strategy:** Analysed pricing, distribution and digital execution of a fast-growing consumer electronics brand.

## Additional Information

- **Other Experience**
  - **Floor Manager & Content Ideator,** The Shoe Inn, Romsey (Feb–Jun 2026): led front-of-house team and ran the content calendar.
  - **Social Media Coordinator,** Freelance (2023–2025): grew brand visibility by 50%+ for early-stage clients.
  - **Co-Founder,** Teen Queue India (2020–2022): built a youth media platform; 50+ podcasts and blogs.
  - **Home Tutor,** Self-employed (2020–2025): five students, 20% average improvement.
- **Volunteering**
  - **Tutor and Social Media Manager,** Instilt Educate (2024–2025).
  - **PR Officer,** Rotaract Club of Inspiria (2022–2023): co-organised UDDHAV Zonal Meet, 100+ attendees.
  - **Event Host,** Public Triumph, Inspiria Knowledge Campus.
- **Certifications (LinkedIn Learning, 2026):** Strategic AI Prompting for Managers; Compliance and Regulations for Generative AI; AI and Business Strategy: Case Studies; Improve Business Process Modelling with Generative AI.
- **Tools & Languages:** Excel, Google Workspace, Canva, CRM fundamentals, prompt engineering; English (IELTS 7.5), Hindi, Marwari, Bengali (elementary).